

To allow a fallback proxy to function correctly without being intercepted by the Next.js App Router's custom 404 handler, you need to **remove or rename the `not-found.tsx` file** from the root of your `app/` directory. [YouTube](#)

If you still need custom 404 pages for specific segments of your application, you can implement them in one of the following ways:

- **Scope the `not-found.tsx` file to a specific route group** by placing it within a route segment folder (e.g., `app/dashboard/not-found.tsx`). This way, it will only handle 404s within that specific route and its children, allowing other unmatched routes to fall through to your proxy logic.
- **Remove the global `not-found.tsx` file entirely.** This will revert to the default Next.js 404 behavior for all unmatched routes, which might be more amenable to server-level or middleware-based proxy/rewrite rules.
- **Utilize a custom server or a service like Cloudflare Workers** to manage the proxy logic outside of the Next.js routing system, giving you more control over the fallback behavior before Next.js processes the request. [GitHub +4](#)

By removing the top-level `not-found.tsx` file, Next.js won't immediately serve a 404 page for unmatched routes, giving your proxy logic (likely defined in `next.config.js` as a `rewrite`) the opportunity to attempt a fallback. Ensure your `rewrite` configuration in `next.config.js` is correctly set up to handle the desired fallback URL. [GitHub +4](#)